



**KOBALT GEN3
VISUAL BRAND LANGUAGE GUIDE**

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OVERVIEW

Background

A Visual Brand Language establishes visual parameters to guide product design and ensure consistent interpretation of the brand across multiple products, categories and manufacturers. With the success of Classic Kobalt, an opportunity to update the visual was identified.

Intent

- VBL creates visual associations between the product and the brand.
- VBL is a living document that will help reduce development time and consistently deliver brand-worthy product.





LOGO STANDARDS

For Product Design and Development purposes, this is the logo and badge that identify our brand.

The logo consists of the word "KOBALT" in a bold, blue, sans-serif font. The letter "O" is replaced by a blue hexagon with a white "K" inside.

Primary logo for product application. The block can be removed when sizing and manufacturability is a concern. (For example: embossed logo on forged metal part)

Logo for packaging and graphic application only. Block logo can used for product that allows a secondary logo application. (For example, a decal label on a truck-box)

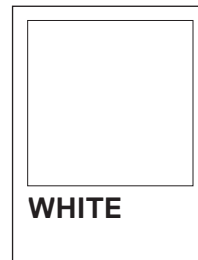
Kobalt Logo Outline

Logo Height		Stroke Width		When the manufacturing process of the Kobalt logo requires spacing and sizing modifications, follow these guidelines depending on the needed size of the logo.
0.060 in			0.004 in	
0.070 in			0.004 in	
0.080 in			0.004 in	
0.090 in			0.004 in	
0.100 in			0.005 in	
0.110 in			0.0055 in	
0.120 in			0.006 in	
0.130 in			0.006 in	
0.140 in			0.006 in	
0.150 in			0.007 in	
0.200 in			0.007 in	
0.250 in			0.007 in	
0.375 in			0.008 in	
0.500 in			0.010 in	



When using the KOBALT logo on the product, the goal is to create as much contrast between the tool and the logo.

First preference for placement of Kobalt Logo

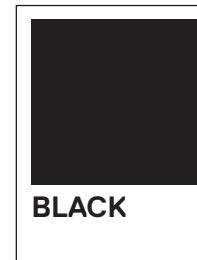


Second preference for placement of Kobalt Logo



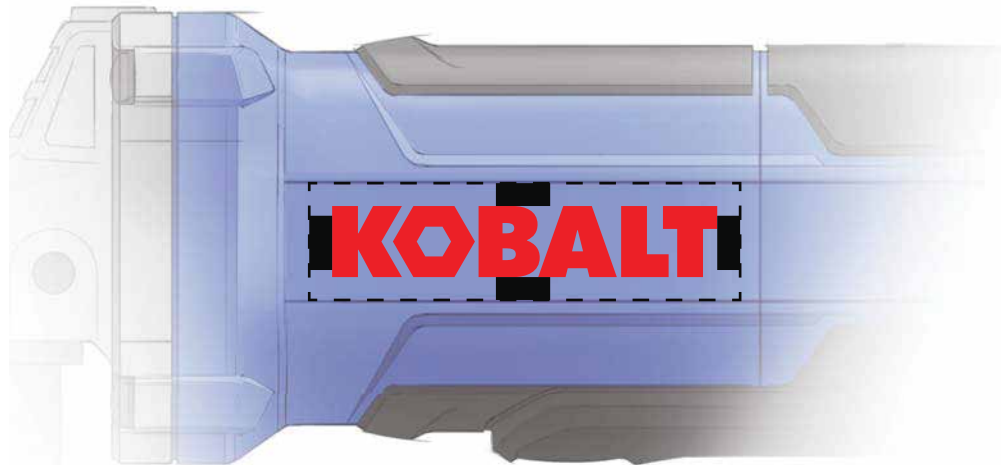
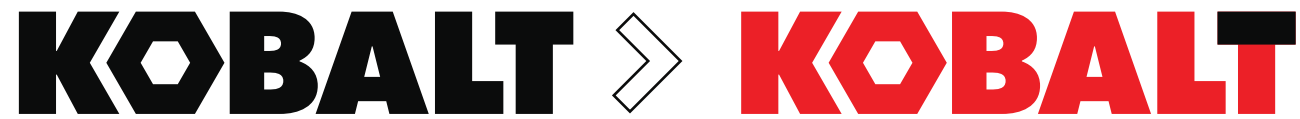
On product that is silver, create as much contrast as possible with the following colors:

Silver Background



Depending on the application, the KOBALT logo can be highlighted via alternate production methods such as grinding, among others.

The KOBALT logo should be used without the block when applying it to product. Follow this guide for creating the preferred minimum space.



When applying the logo to a product, there should be a minimum amount of space around the logo. An easy guide is taking the top section of the T and placing it around the logo.

The top section of the “T” can be used to create a space around the logo, ensuring proper spacing.

This creates the suggested minimum space required for the KOBALT logo in between the surface area of the tool.

Kobalt Logo: Application Methods.

Raised Logo

KOBALT



Ideal method for applying a permanent mark on plastic and metal parts that may require pad printing. Also ideal for grinding off logo on metal parts.

Lowered Logo

KOBALT



Ideal method for applying a permanent mark on metal and plastic parts that do not require additional processes. The KOBALT logo can be highlighted by using a smoother texture or finish vs. the texture on the product. Can be used for both plastic and metal parts.

Additional logo application (but not limited to)

Pad Printing



Mold Insert



Decal



The Hex K is the seal of approval.
It should be used thoughtfully.

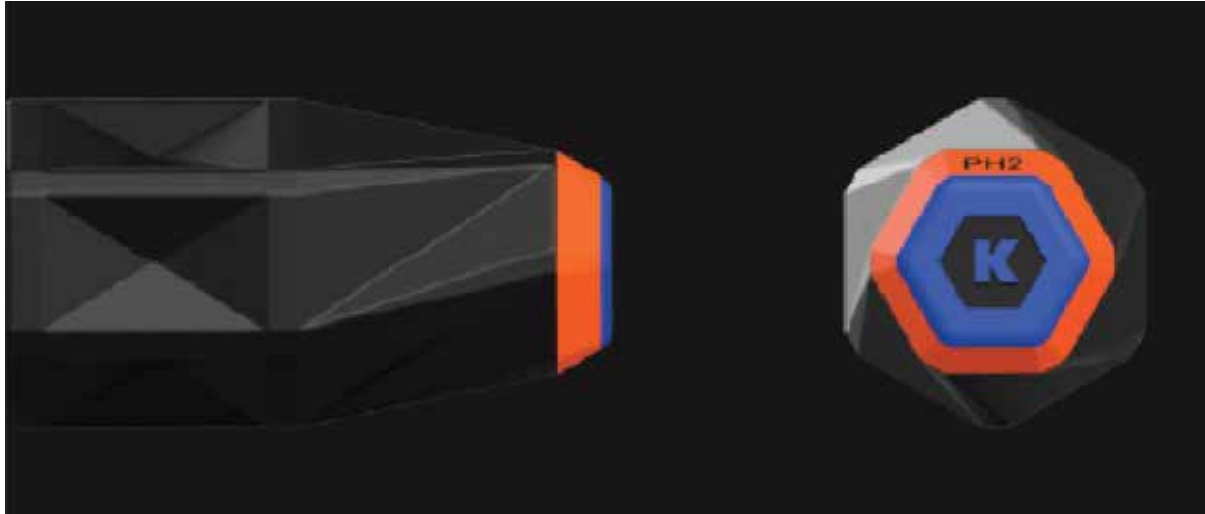


The Hex K and Kobalt logo should never be adjusted or combined.
Do not lock up the Kobalt logo and Hex K, or eliminate any component of either of the marks.



Principles of the Hex K

Whenever possible, make the Hex K placement thoughtfully integral to the design



The Hex K is secondary - never the only identifier

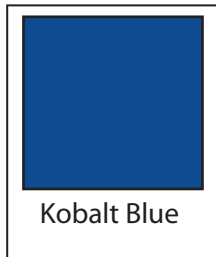




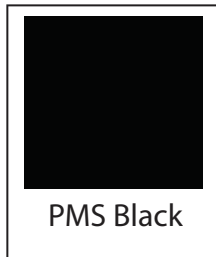
VISUAL DESIGN ELEMENTS

KOBALT Color Palette

Primary Color Palette These are the main colors associated with the brand. The primary palette should be heavily used.

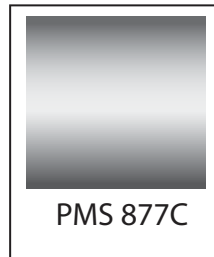


Kobalt Blue



PMS Black

C: 0
M: 0
Y: 0
K: 100

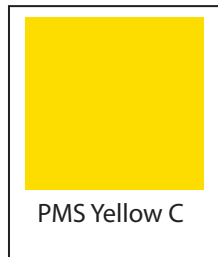


PMS 877C

To ensure the correct color is matched, measure the L* a* b* values using a spectrophotometer set to D65, with a 10° viewing angle. Formula CMC 2:1 Tolerance: ΔE 2.0

Color match for painted metals and for logos

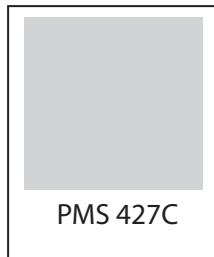
Accent Palette This colors are used very thoughtfully and only in small amounts.



PMS Yellow C

C: 0
M: 13
Y: 100
K: 0

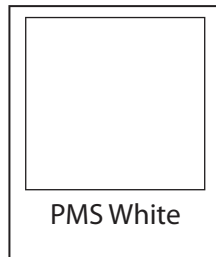
-To be used in small proportions.



PMS 427C

C: 0
M: 0
Y: 0
K: 11

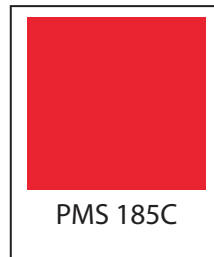
-KOBALT Name
-Text/Graphics



PMS White

C: 0
M: 0
Y: 0
K: 0

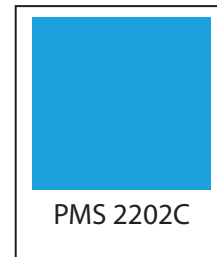
-KOBALT Name
-Text/Graphics



PMS 185C

C: 0
M: 96
Y: 80
K: 0

SAE Color Only

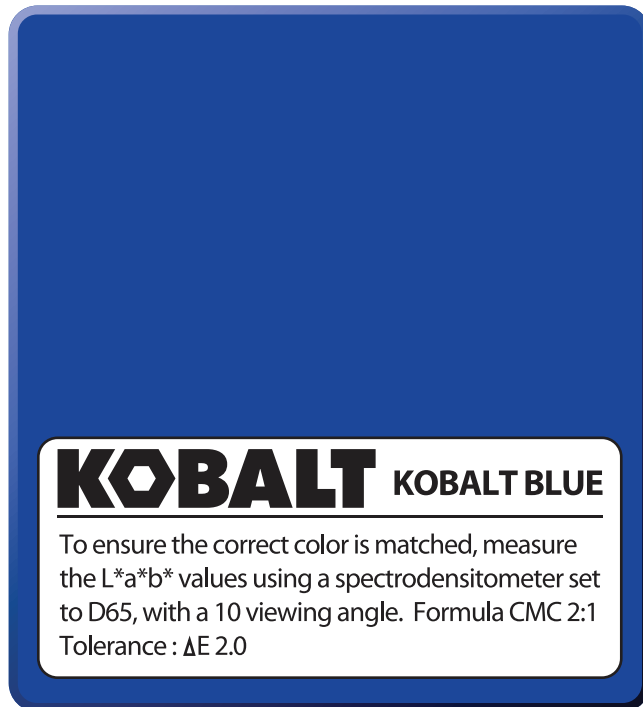


PMS 2202C

C: 90
M: 0
Y: 5
K: 0

Metric Color Only

KOBALT Blue: Color Management Process



Phase One:

1. KOBALT blue color chips are stored and kept by the Product Design & Development team.
2. When the KOBALT blue has to be specified to the vendor, the plastic chip has to be sent to the vendor. **Do not specify PMS or Pantone Numbers.**
3. The Vendor is required to work with their colorant supplier to develop a sample color chips that should be within the tolerance defined on the KOBALT color chip.
4. Once the vendor has created the color chip, they will need to send it to the KOBALT team in charge of the project. The sample chips will be measured by the Product Design & Development team using a spectrophotometer to verify that the sample chips are within the allowed tolerance.
5. The KOBALT Team in charged of the project will sign and approve the best chip tested and return it to vendor.

Kobalt Primary Font:

Replica should be used whenever possible in print applications and packaging. It comes in three weights: Bold, Regular and Light.

Replica

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

1234567890!@#%&():;,,.

Regular.
Regular italic.

Aa Aa

Bold.
Bold italic.

Aa Aa

Light.
Light italic.

Aa Aa



Kobalt Secondary Font:

United can be used to create differentiation of features and callouts. It can be used for on-product graphics.

United

ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ

abcdefghijklmnopqrstuvwxyz

1234567890!@#%&()::,,

Examples of different fonts but not limited to the following:

Regular
Bold

Aa Aa

Extended
Bold

Aa Aa

ITALIC REGULAR
ITALIC EXTENDED

A A

DO NOT USE SERIFF FONT

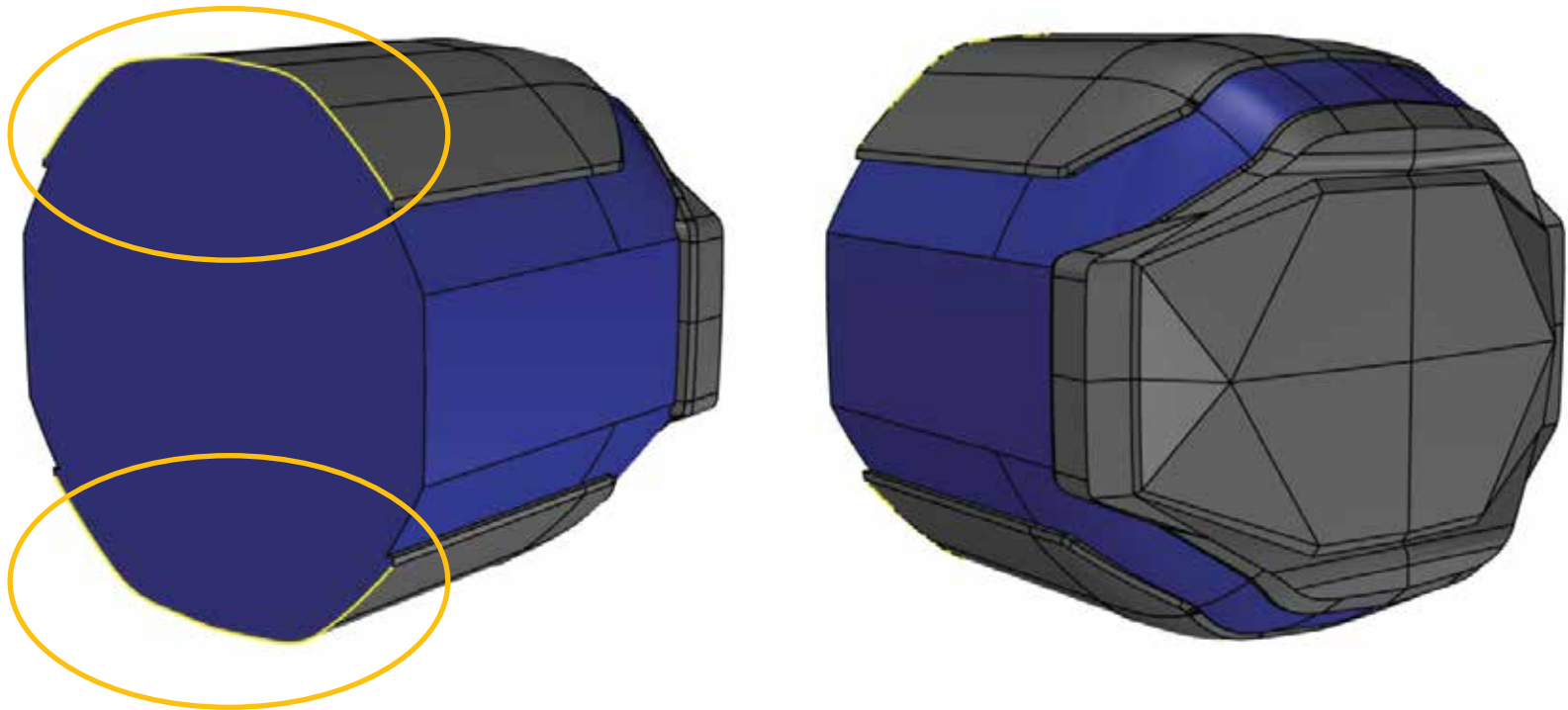


The G3 VBL is an evolutionary step from G1 and continues to be built off the hexagon and trapezoid shapes.

In development, we landed on a “Rounded Trap” shape for the primary form of the barrel.



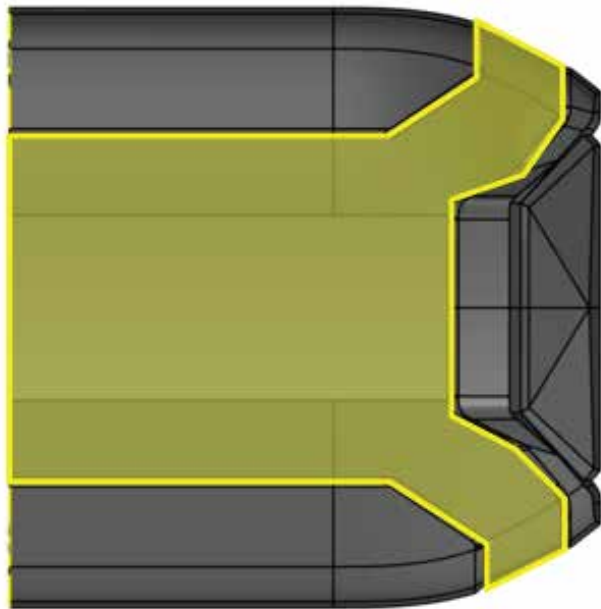
Rounded Trapezoid Shape.



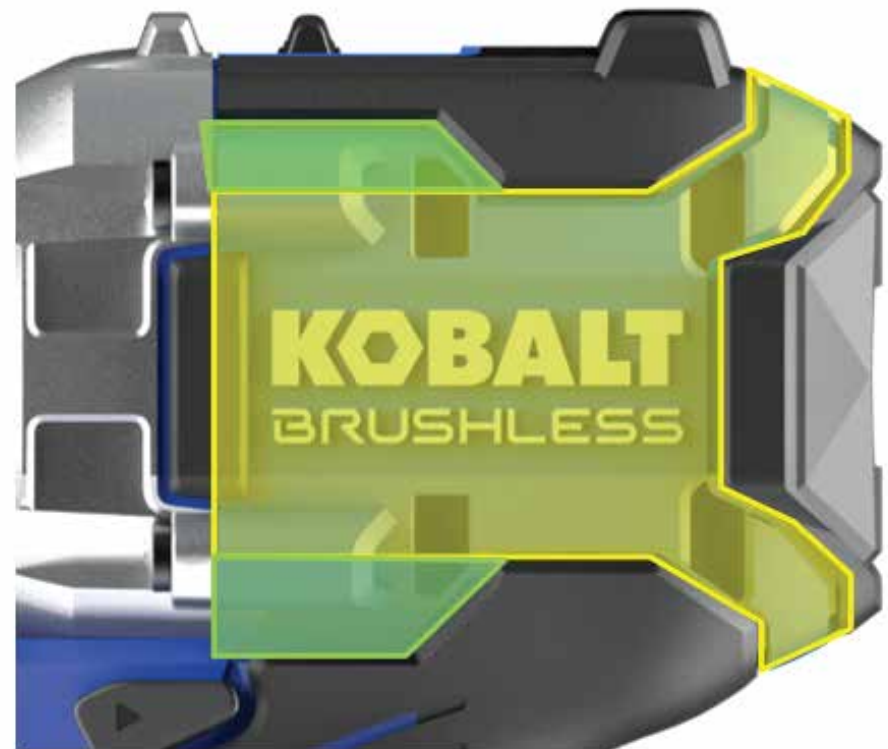
The G1 VBL was build off an “X” theme.
Due to the decrease size in tools we modified this by removing the front legs of the X as the primary badge shape.

Secondary shapes can be added into the over-mold to go around features such as screw bosses and venting.

Primary badge shape

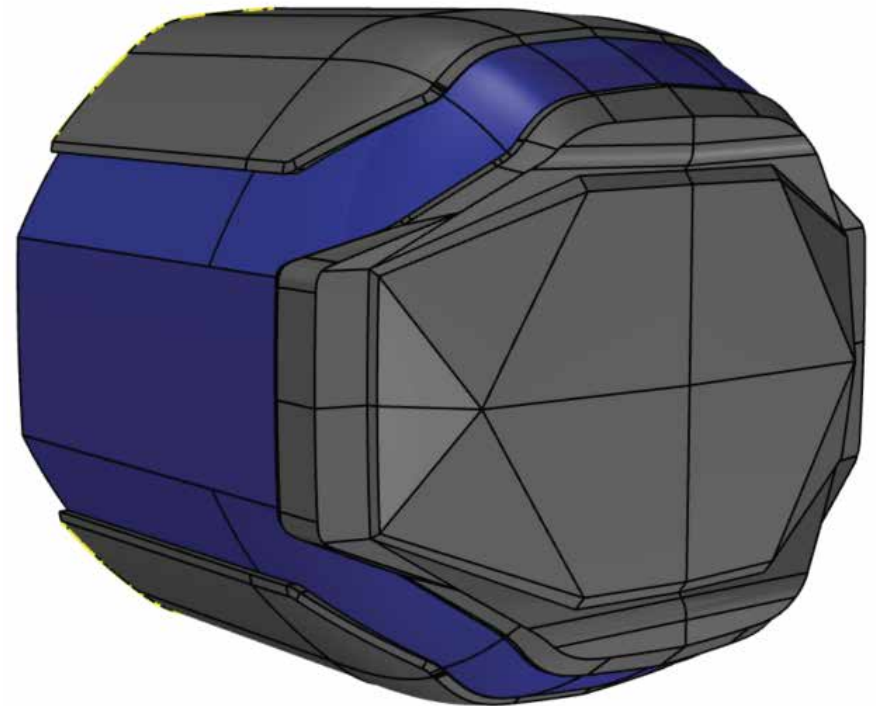
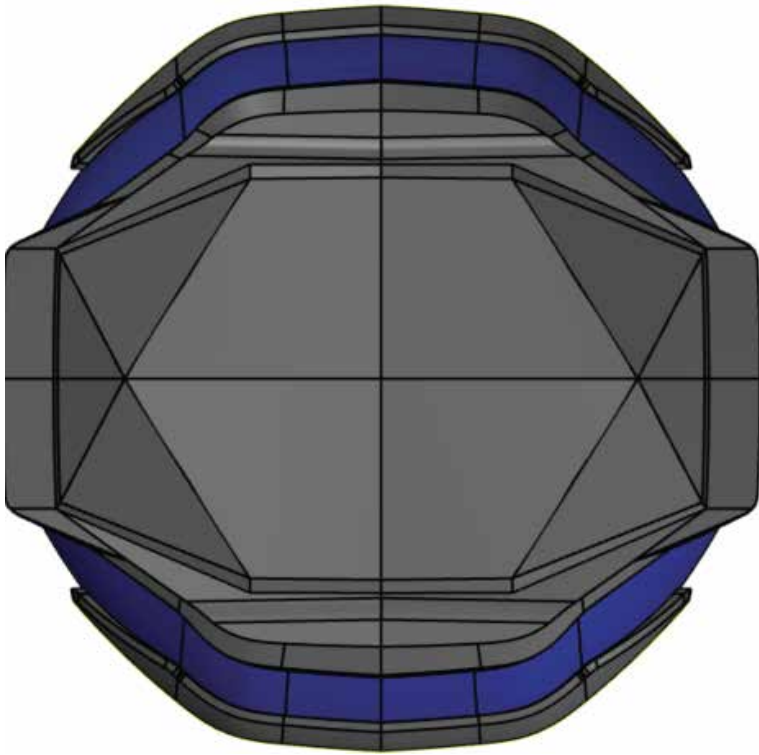


Primary badge shape with secondary shapes to go around the screw boss and vents.



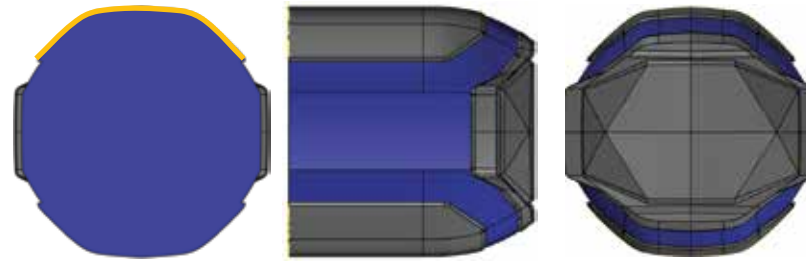
The “end cap” of the barrel form is strong theme and needs to be include on all tools where applicable.

“stick tools” like a multi tool, or right-angle impact wrench will not allow this form due to where the battery is placed.

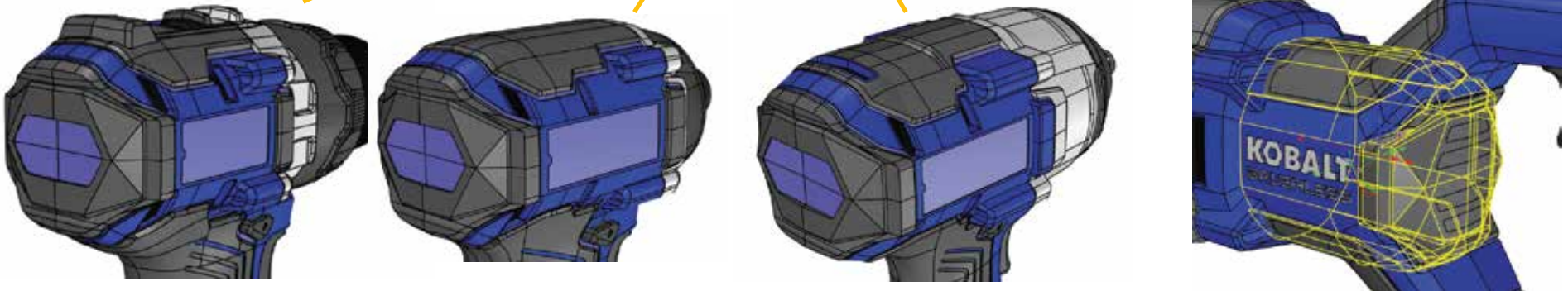


The hexagon shape is not a perfect hex and can be scaled with the barrel housing to fit the tool. Care needs to be taken so that the hex shape is not visual too distorted.

The Core barrel form can be adapted to most tools by scaling to fit the provided clearance spheres.

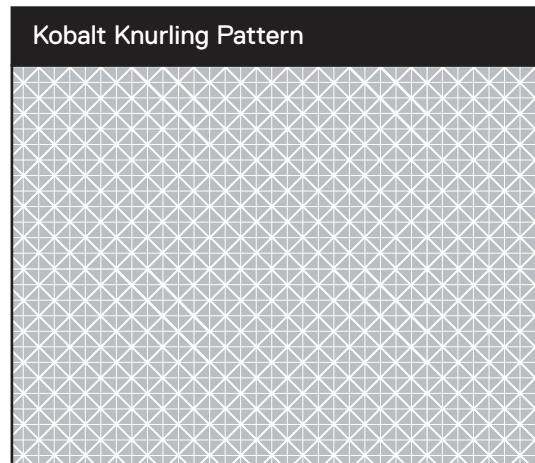
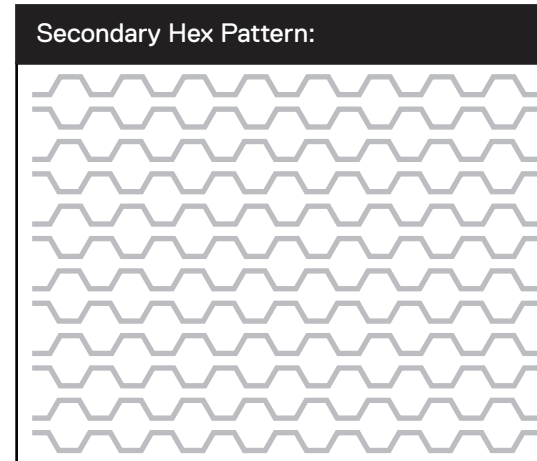
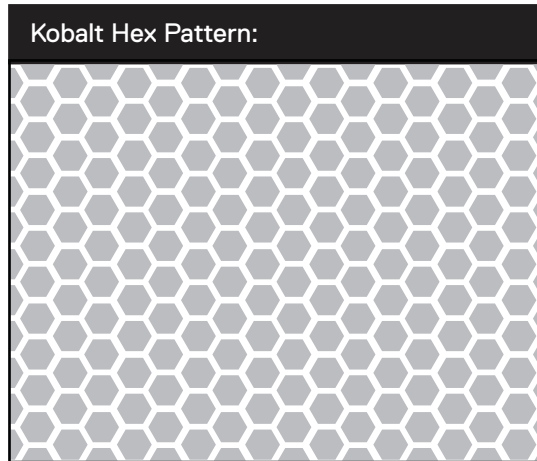


In some cases, the barrel form can be scaled in a non-uniform manner. The Recip is a good example where the barrel form is scaled more in the vertical direction. Care needs to be taken that the hex shape on the back is not visually distorted too much.



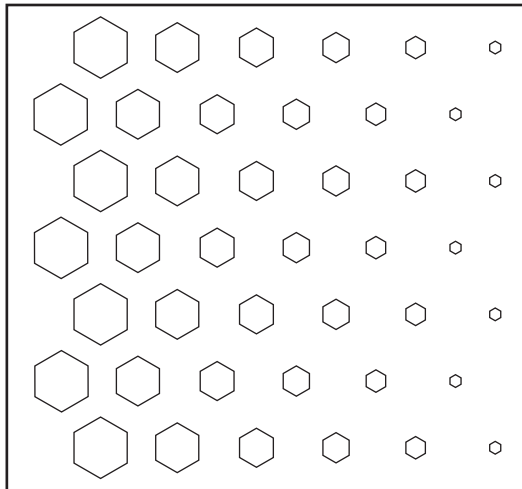
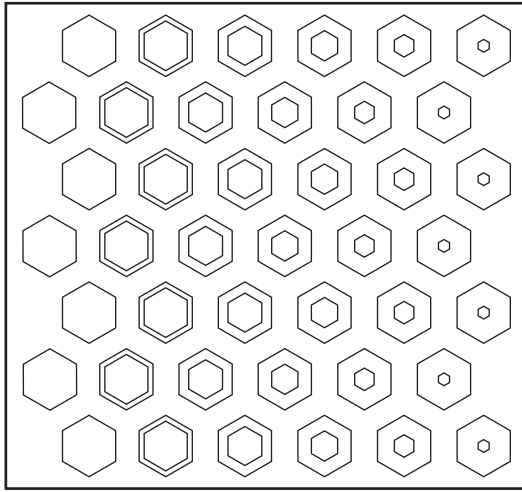
Visual Design Elements: Legacy Textures

Kobalt Classic tools have always used the legacy texture patterns below. Since Kobalt Gen3 carries on the legacy of Kobalt Classic these texture patterns can still be thoughtfully applied where necessary.



Visual Design Elements: New Texture Pattern

Driving home the Kobalt Hex design is the new texture pattern - a pattern of diminishing Hex shapes.

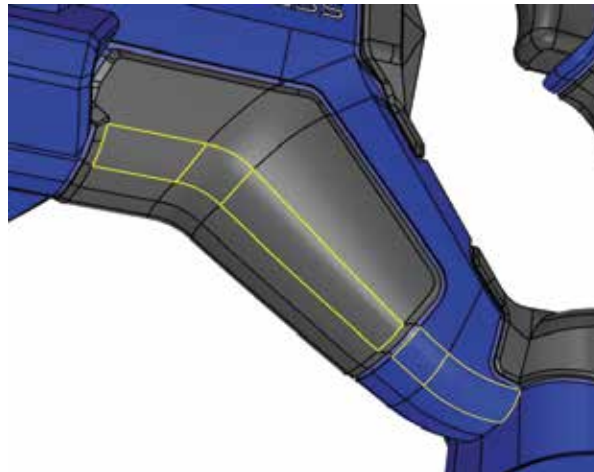


The diminishing Hex pattern as used on overmold - with the diminishing center showing Blue through the black overmold.

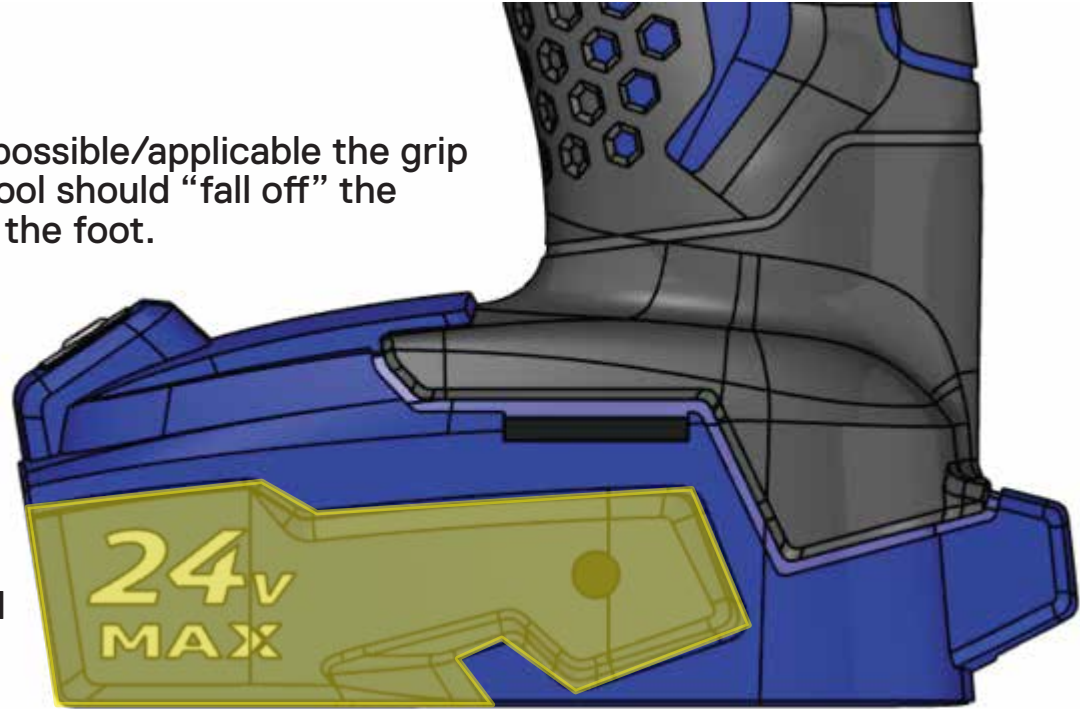


The “soft trap” shape in the barrel form will also be used in areas such as the outer surfaces of the support arms for the recip saw and circ saw.

The inner side of the support arm will keep the hard-edge chamfer as a carry over from G1

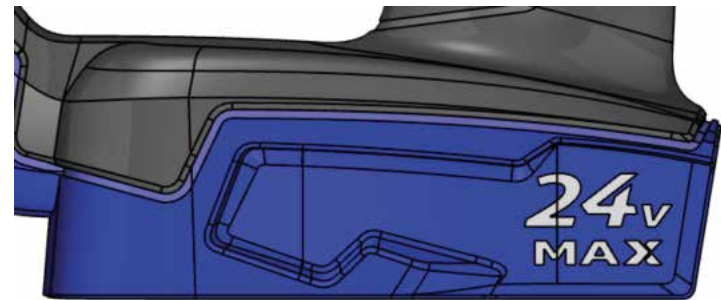


Where possible/applicable the grip of the tool should “fall off” the back of the foot.

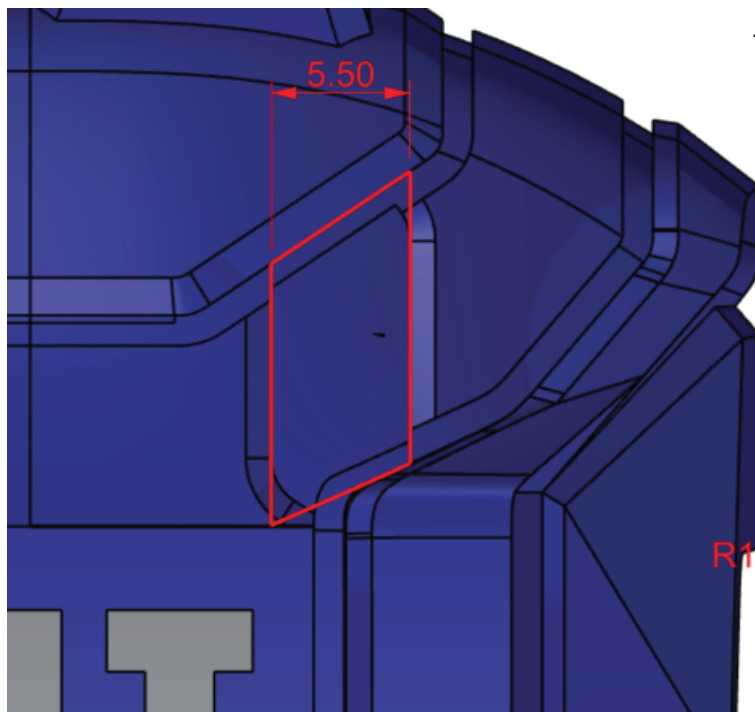


The belt hook boss is now integrated with the battery catch area.

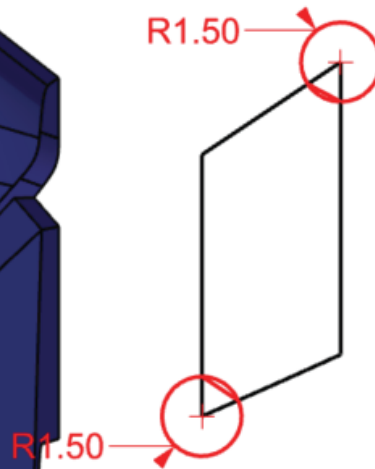
The integrated “belt hook boss” will remain on tools that will not have a belt hook (circ saw, recip saw etc.) The screw hole is simply removed.



Vent is 5.5mm wide.
The top and bottom follow the intersection
of the chamfer/hard plastic before the penny groove.

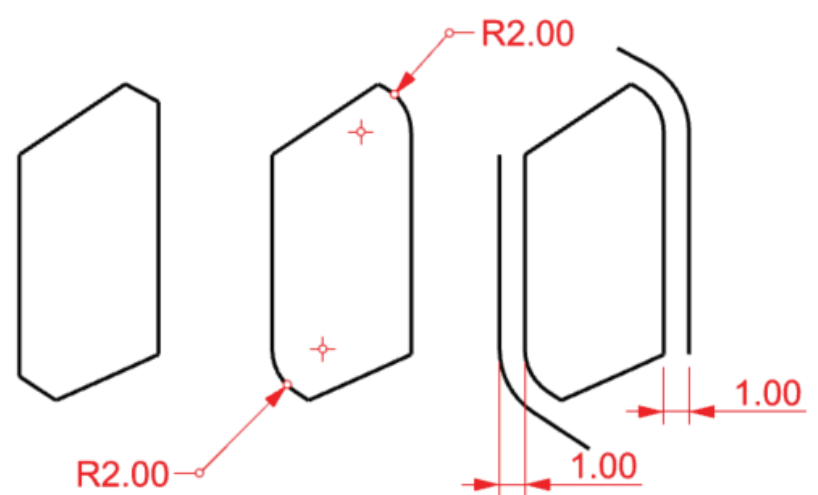


Trim corners to a 1.5mm radius.



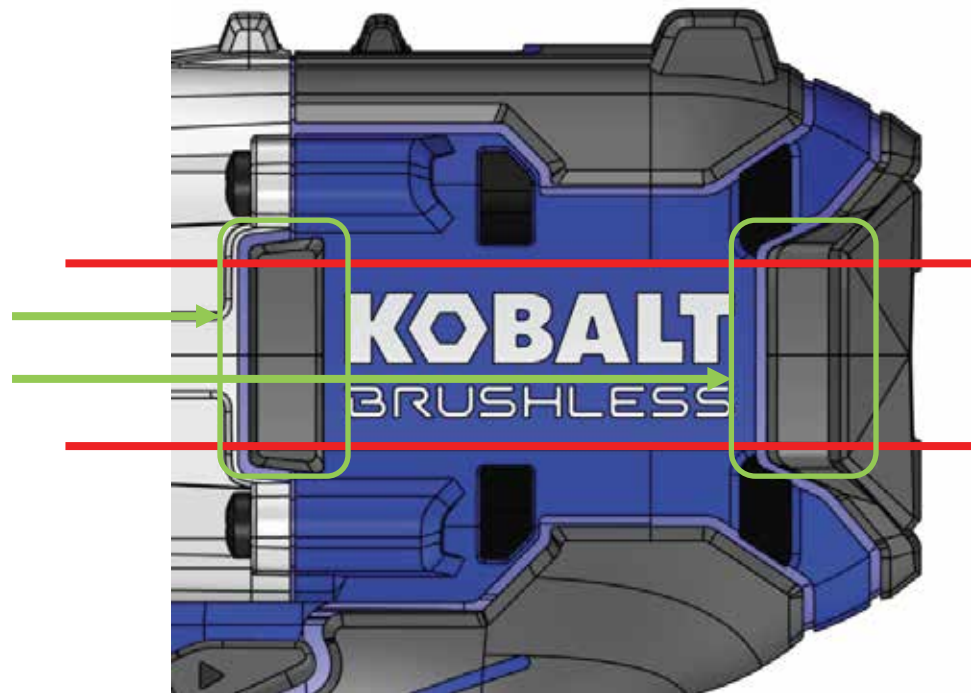
Add 2mm radius

offset 1mm for
chamfer



chamfer depth is .5mm

Front and back bumper are similar is scale from G1 but a slight update in design.



The Logo maintains the same spacing around it.





PRODUCT DESIGN EXAMPLES





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